CROCHET PATTERN

Poinsettia

Table Runner



AI preview image

A lush Christmas runner: three large three-layer red poinsettias and three ivory poinsettias on a bed of dark green leaves, green and gold ferns, red berries and gold bead sprigs. Every piece is sewn onto a hidden crochet spine.

ENGLISH · US CROCHET TERMS

DESIGNFRSHOP

Poinsettia Table Runner

SKILL LEVEL	Intermediate (many small pieces, simple stitches)
FINISHED SIZE	about 40 × 117 cm (15½ × 46 in), measured over the leaf tips
FLOWERS	3 large red (about 25 cm across) + 3 ivory (about 16 cm across)
TIME	about 38–51 hours, plus drying time

Materials

DK / light worsted (CYC 3) cotton or cotton blend. Amounts include about 20 % extra; balls are counted at 120 m per 50 g.

COLOUR	LENGTH	50 G BALLS	USED FOR
Christmas red	410 m	4	middle + inner bracts, rings, berries
Burgundy	205 m	2	back bracts, back rings, berry stems
Ivory / cream	160 m	2	ivory flowers
Dark green	350 m	3	spine, leaves, dark ferns
Olive green	110 m	1	olive ferns
Antique gold	165 m	2	gold ferns

- Crochet hook 3.5 mm (US E/4); tapestry needle; sewing needle; stitch markers; rust-proof pins; scissors
- 75 gold beads, 6–8 mm: 48 for the flower centres + 27 for the bead sprigs; strong red and gold sewing thread
- Optional: fabric stiffener (or white PVA glue mixed 1:1 with water) and a blocking mat

Gauge

> 21 sc and 22 rows = 10 cm (4 in) with the 3.5 mm hook. Gauge decides the size of every piece, so check it. A firm stitch keeps the petals crisp. If your pieces come out bigger, the runner gets wider and you need more yarn.

Abbreviations & techniques

CH	chain
SL ST	slip stitch
SC	single crochet
HDC	half double crochet
DC	double crochet
DEC	sc2tog: insert in next st, pull up a loop, insert in next st, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through all 3 loops
MR	magic ring
BLO	back loop only
ST(S) / SP	stitch(es) / space
PICOT	ch 3, sl st in the 3rd ch from the hook (makes a small bump, not counted as a st)
[ ]	stitch count at the end of a round or piece

Pieces worked around a chain

> All petals, bracts and the dark green leaves are made the same way. **Ch N.** The 2nd ch from the hook is at the **tip**; the last ch (the first one you made) is at the **base**.
>
> **Side A:** work from the 2nd ch from the hook up to the ch before the last ch (N−2 sts). **Base:** 3 sc in the last ch. **Side B:** turn the chain and work the same stitches in reverse order into the free loops on the other side (N−2 sts). Then make the tip and join with a sl st in the first sc.
>
> **Rnd 2** (on the larger pieces) works one stitch into each stitch of Rnd 1 along both sides, adds stitches at the base and makes a pointed picot tip. Working the petals' Rnd 2 in back loops leaves a raised line that outlines the petal like in the photo.

US and UK terms

This pattern uses US terms. UK: sc = dc, hdc = htr, dc = tr.

Work smart

Make the pieces in batches, one type at a time. Leave the long tails: you sew with them. Weave in a tail only after the piece is sewn on.

Part 1 · The pieces

Every piece is made separately. Each flower becomes a "flower group" with its leaves, ferns and berries sewn on the back; the six groups are then sewn onto the spine.

PIECE	COLOUR	MAKE	SIZE
Spine	Dark green	1	100 × 5 cm
Back bract (red flower)	Burgundy	24	11.0 × 4.7 cm
Middle bract (red flower)	Red	24	9.1 × 4.7 cm
Inner bract (red flower)	Red	18	5.6 × 2.5 cm
Rings (red flower)	Burgundy 1 + red 2 per flower	9	—
Back petal (ivory flower)	Ivory	24	7.2 × 4.7 cm
Front petal (ivory flower)	Ivory	18	4.7 × 2.5 cm
Rings (ivory flower)	Ivory, 2 per flower	6	—
Leaf	Dark green	24	8.1 × 3.4 cm
Fern	Dark green / olive / gold	12 / 12 / 18	12.3 × 7.3 cm
Berry + stem	Red + burgundy	54 + 18	1.8 cm
Bead sprig	3 gold beads	9	—

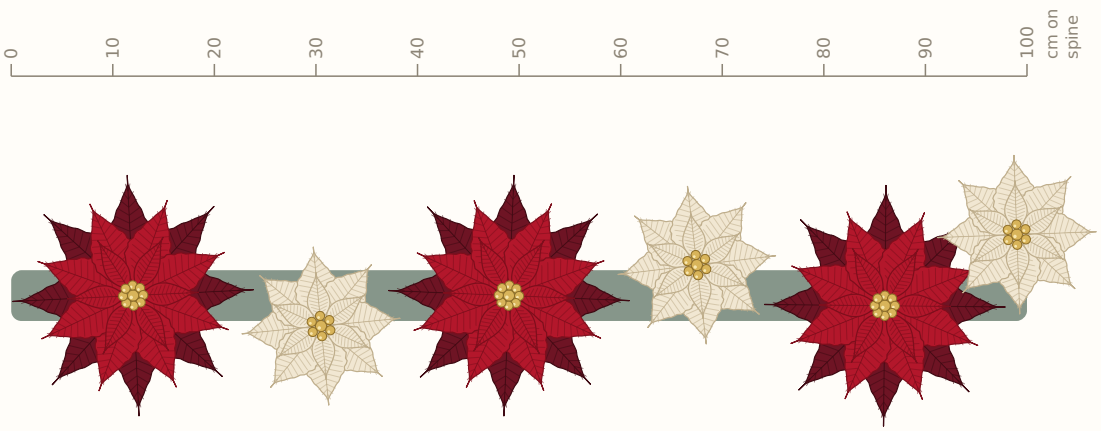


THE GREEN PIECES, BERRIES AND SPRIGS

> Sizes are measured flat after blocking, at the gauge given. The flower order from the top end is red, ivory, red, ivory, red, ivory, with the ivory flowers set a little to the side for the relaxed zig-zag look of the photo.

Part 2 · The spine

COLOUR	Dark green, so it disappears under the leaves.
FOUNDATION	Ch 211.
ROW 1	Sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each ch across **[210]**.
ROWS 2–11	Ch 1, turn, sc in each st across **[210]**.
FINISH	Fasten off and weave in the ends. Pin it flat to 100 × 5 cm and let it dry.
MARK	Mark the flower centres with pins, measured from the top end: red 12 cm; ivory 30.5 cm (3 cm left); red 49 cm; ivory 67.5 cm (3 cm right); red 86 cm (1 cm left); ivory 99 cm (6 cm right). Left and right are seen from the top end.



FLOWER CENTRES ON THE SPINE (TOP END ON THE LEFT)

The flowers overlap a little, just like in the photo: each ivory flower sits on the tips of the red bracts next to it. The last ivory flower overlaps the lower right of the third red flower.

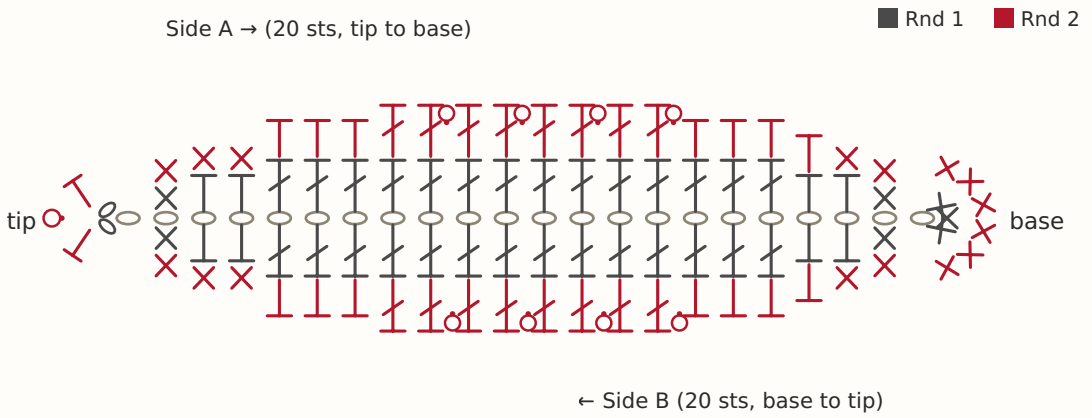
Part 3 · Red poinsettia (make 3)

Three layers: 8 burgundy back bracts, 8 red middle bracts and 6 small red inner bracts, each layer on its own ring, with 9 gold beads in the centre.

Back bract · burgundy · make 24

Rnd 1. Ch 22. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 14 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[20]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 14 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[20]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[43 sts + ch-2 tip]**

Rnd 2. Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 3 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 4 times, hdc in next 4 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[20]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 4 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 4 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 3 sts **[20]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[48 sts + 9 picots]**



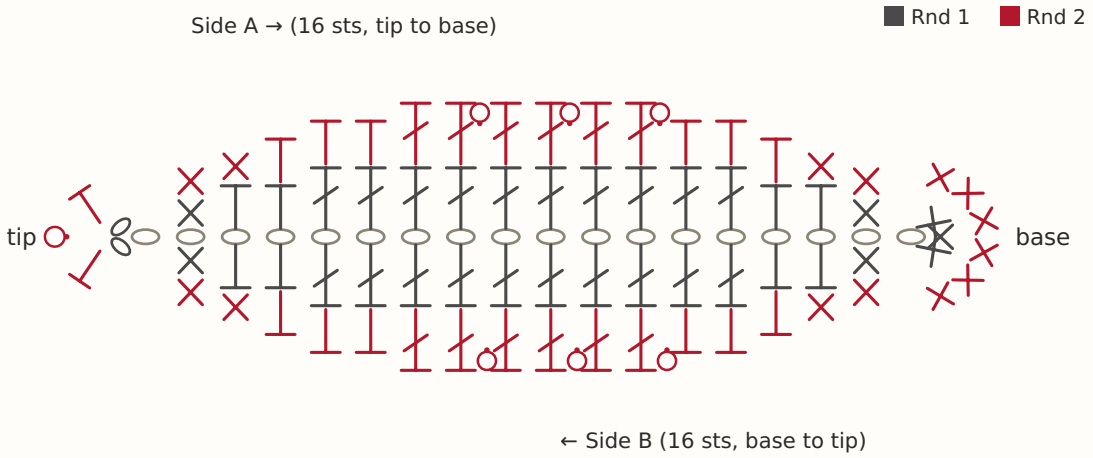
BACK BRACT, RND 1 AND RND 2

Part 3 · Red poinsettia (continued)

Middle bract · red · make 24

Rnd 1. Ch 18. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 10 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[16]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 10 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[16]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[35 sts + ch-2 tip]**

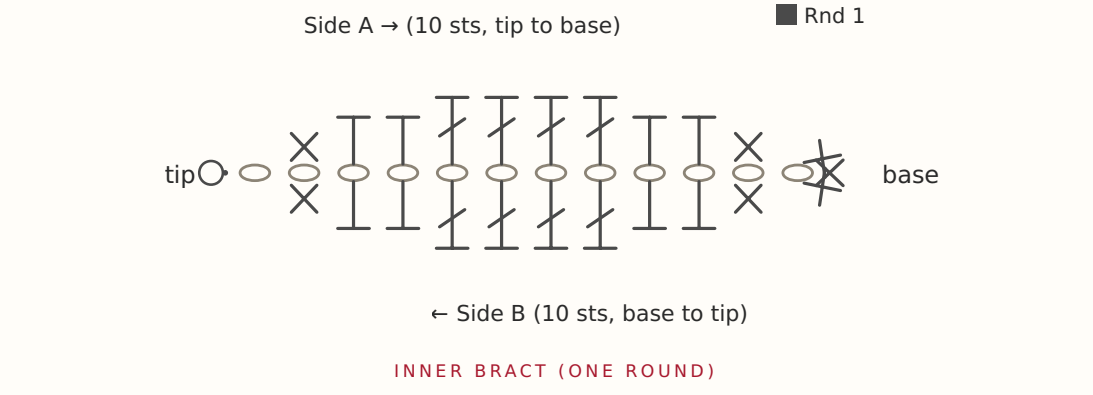
Rnd 2. Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 3 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[16]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 3 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 3 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[16]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[40 sts + 7 picots]**



MIDDLE BRACT, RND 1 AND RND 2

Inner bract · red · make 18

Rnd 1. Ch 12. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 4 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[10]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 4 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[10]**. Tip: picot (ch 3, sl st in 3rd ch from hook), sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[23 sts + tip picot]**



INNER BRACT (ONE ROUND)

Part 3 · Red poinsettia (continued)

Rings · make 1 of each per flower

BACK RING · BURGUNDY

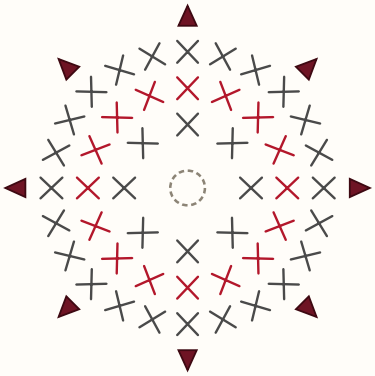
Rnd 1. MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. **Rnd 3.** Ch 1, (sc in next st, 2 sc in next st) 8 times, sl st to first sc **[24]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

MIDDLE RING · RED

Rnd 1. MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

INNER RING · RED

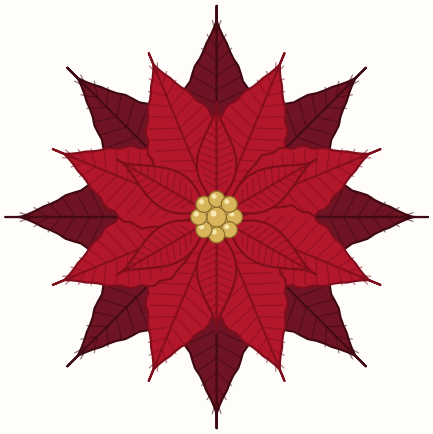
Rnd 1. MR, 6 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[6]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[12]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.



BACK RING: ONE BRACT EVERY 3RD ST

Build the flower

1. Back layer: sew the base of one burgundy bract to every 3rd st of the back ring (8 bracts, evenly spaced). Use the bract's tail and sew through both loops.
2. Middle layer: sew one red middle bract to every 2nd st of the middle ring.
3. Inner layer: sew one inner bract to every 2nd st of the inner ring.
4. Stack the layers: middle on back, inner on middle. Turn each layer so its bracts sit **between** the bracts below. Sew the three rings together through all layers.
5. Centre: sew 9 gold beads to the inner ring: 1 in the middle and 8 in a circle around it, touching.



FINISHED RED FLOWER, ABOUT 25 CM ACROSS



AI preview image

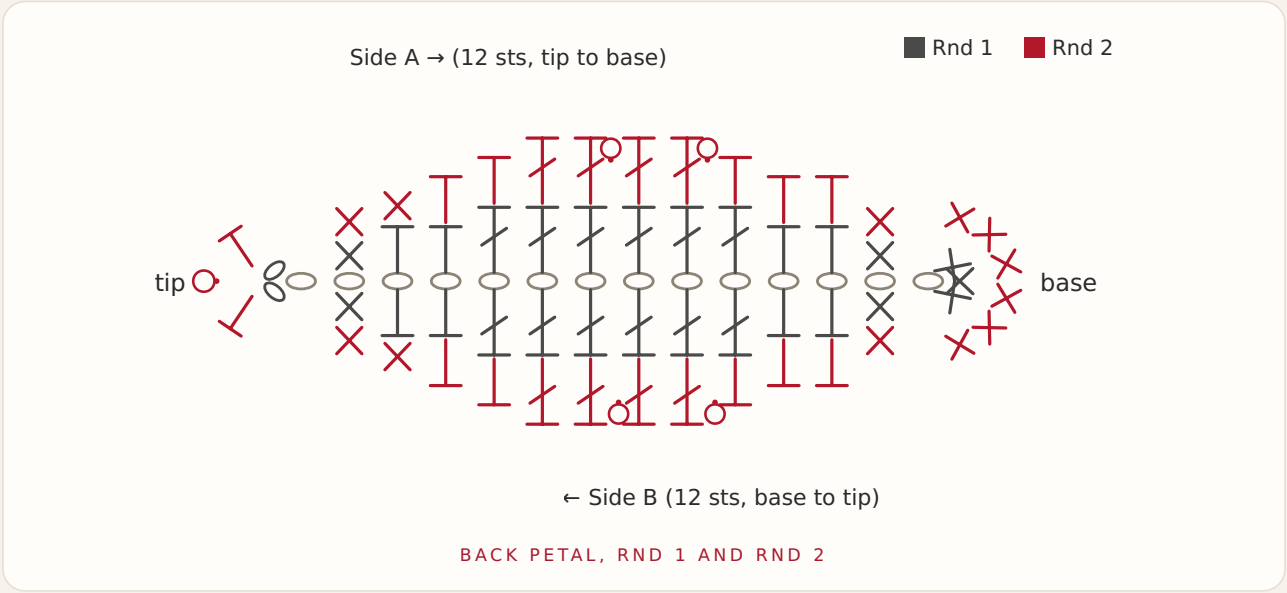
Part 4 · Ivory poinsettia (make 3)

Two ivory layers: 8 back petals and 6 front petals, with 7 gold beads in the centre.

Back petal · make 24

Rnd 1. Ch 14. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 6 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[12]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 6 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[12]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[27 sts + ch-2 tip]**

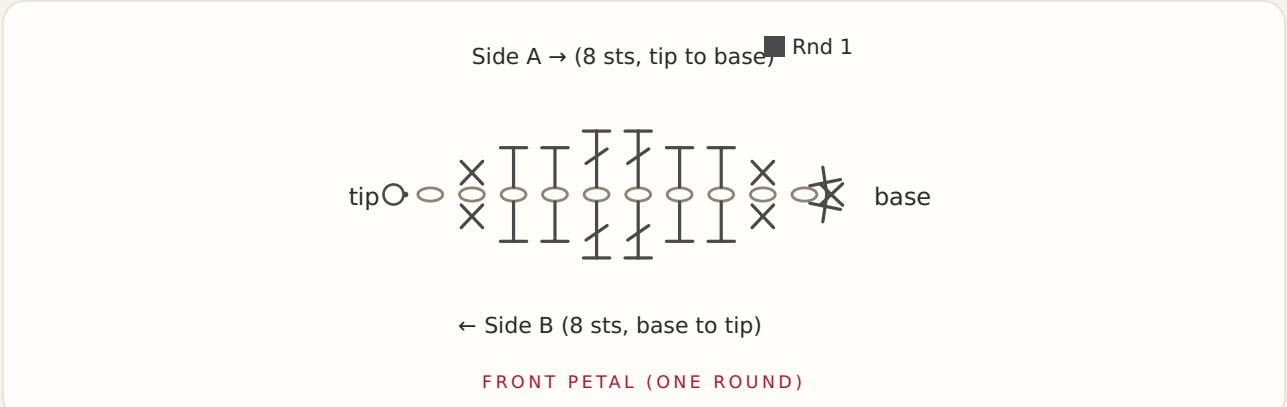
Rnd 2. Ch 1. In back loops only, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: sc in next 2 sts, hdc in next 2 sts, (dc in next 2 sts, picot) 2 times, hdc in next 3 sts, sc in next st **[12]**; base: 2 sc in each of next 3 sts **[6]**; Side B: sc in next st, hdc in next 3 sts, (picot, dc in next 2 sts) 2 times, hdc in next 2 sts, sc in next 2 sts **[12]**; tip: (hdc, picot, hdc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[32 sts + 5 picots]**



BACK PETAL, RND 1 AND RND 2

Front petal · make 18

Rnd 1. Ch 10. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 2 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[8]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 2 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[8]**. Tip: picot (ch 3, sl st in 3rd ch from hook), sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[19 sts + tip picot]**



FRONT PETAL (ONE ROUND)

Part 4 · Ivory poinsettia (continued)

Rings · make 1 of each per flower

BACK RING

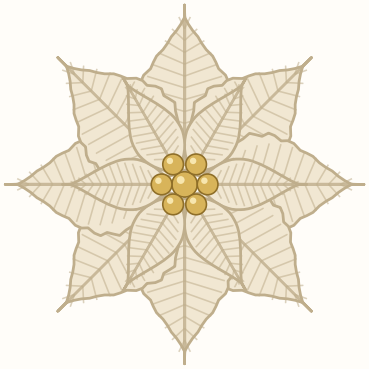
Rnd 1. MR, 8 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[8]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[16]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

FRONT RING

Rnd 1. MR, 6 sc in the ring, sl st to first sc **[6]**. **Rnd 2.** Ch 1, 2 sc in each st, sl st to first sc **[12]**. Fasten off, leave a 30 cm (12 in) tail.

Build the flower

1. Sew one back petal to every 2nd st of the back ring (8 petals).
2. Sew one front petal to every 2nd st of the front ring (6 petals).
3. Put the front layer on the back layer so the front petals sit between the back petals. Sew the rings together.
4. Centre: sew 7 gold beads: 1 in the middle and 6 around it.



FINISHED IVORY FLOWER, ABOUT 16 CM ACROSS



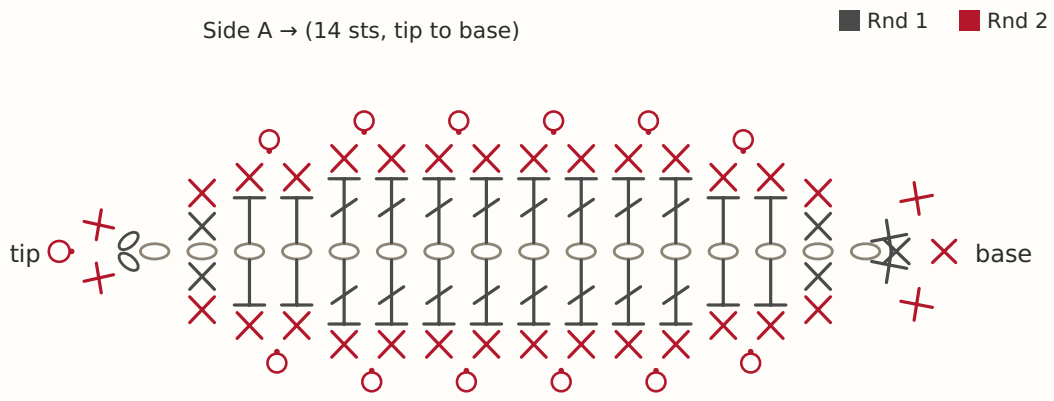
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Part 5 · Leaves

Dark green leaf · make 24

Rnd 1. Ch 16. Side A: sc in 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 8 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[14]**. Base: 3 sc in last ch. Side B: working in the free loops on the other side of the chain, sc in next ch, hdc in next 2 chs, dc in next 8 chs, hdc in next 2 chs, sc in next ch **[14]**. Tip: ch 2, sl st in first sc. **[31 sts + ch-2 tip]**

Rnd 2. Ch 1. In both loops, starting in the same st as the join: Side A: (sc in next 2 sts, picot) 6 times, sc in next 2 sts **[14]**; base: sc in each of next 3 sts **[3]**; Side B: (sc in next 2 sts, picot) 6 times, sc in next 2 sts **[14]**; tip: (sc, picot, sc) in the ch-2 sp. Sl st in first sc. Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[33 sts + 13 picots]**



LEAF, RND 1 AND RND 2 (PICOT EDGE)

> Rnd 2 of the leaf is worked in both loops. The picots give the jagged leaf edge you see in the photo.

Part 5 · Ferns

The lacy fronds are the same pattern in three colours: 12 dark green, 12 olive and 18 gold.

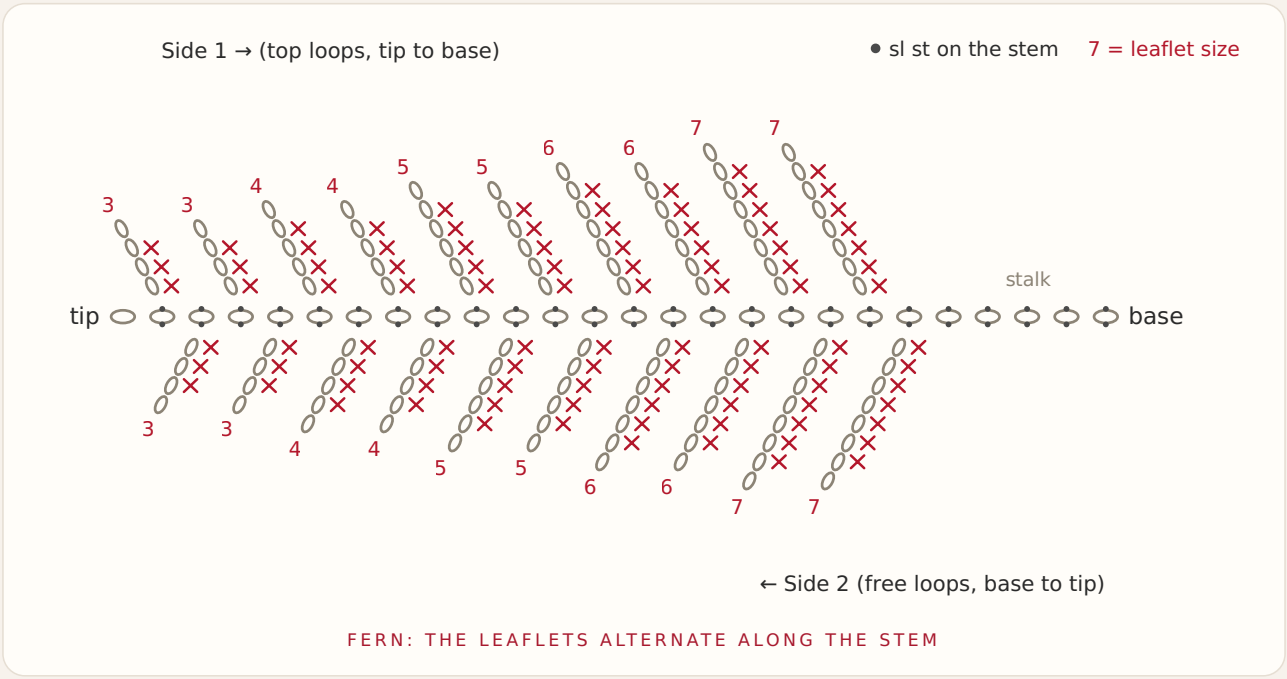
LEAFLET (SIZE K)

Ch k + 1, sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each of the next k − 1 ch **[k sc]**. You end back at the stem. Example: leaflet 5 = ch 6, sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and in the next 4 ch.

FERN

Ch 26. Side 1: sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook (tip). *Make a leaflet, sl st in the next 2 ch*; repeat from * 10 times, with leaflet sizes 3, 3, 4, 4, 5, 5, 6, 6, 7, 7. Sl st in each of the last 4 ch (stalk).

Side 2: turn the work so the free loops of the chain are on top. Sl st in the free loop of each of the first 4 ch. *Sl st in the next 2 ch, make a leaflet*; repeat from * 10 times, with leaflet sizes 7, 7, 6, 6, 5, 5, 4, 4, 3, 3. Sl st in the last ch (tip). Fasten off, leave a 25 cm (10 in) tail. **[20 leaflets, 100 sc]**



FERN: THE LEAFLETS ALTERNATE ALONG THE STEM

> Each fern is about 12.3 cm long and 7.3 cm wide. Pin it flat with the leaflets spread like a feather and spray it with water (or stiffener for the gold ones). Let it dry.

Part 6 · Berries & bead sprigs

Berry · red · make 54

Rnd 1	MR, 6 sc in the ring	[6]
Rnd 2	2 sc in each st	[12]
Rnd 3	(sc in next st, ch 1, skip 1 st) 6 times	[6 sc, 6 ch-1 sps]
Rnd 4	(sc in the sc, sc in the ch-1 sp) 6 times	[12]
Rnd 5	dec 6 times	[6]
Rnd 6	dec 3 times	[3]

Stuff the berry firmly after Rnd 4, using **red yarn scraps**: white stuffing would show through the little holes of Rnd 3. Work Rnds 5 and 6, then close the hole and keep the tail for sewing.

Stem · burgundy · make 18

Ch 9, sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook and in each ch across **[8]**. Fasten off, leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail.

Berry cluster · make 18

Sew 1 berry to the tip of a stem and 1 berry on each side, about 1 cm lower, so the 3 berries touch.

Bead sprig · make 9

Thread 3 gold beads on strong gold thread and sew them into a small triangle on top of each other. Leave the thread ends for sewing on.



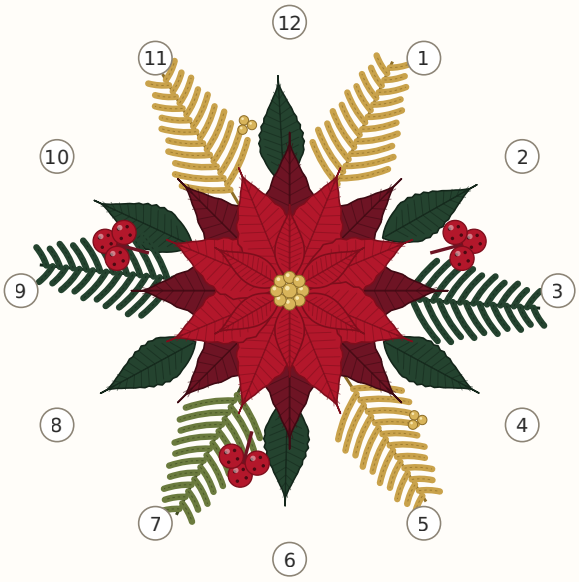
BERRY CLUSTER AND BEAD SPRIG



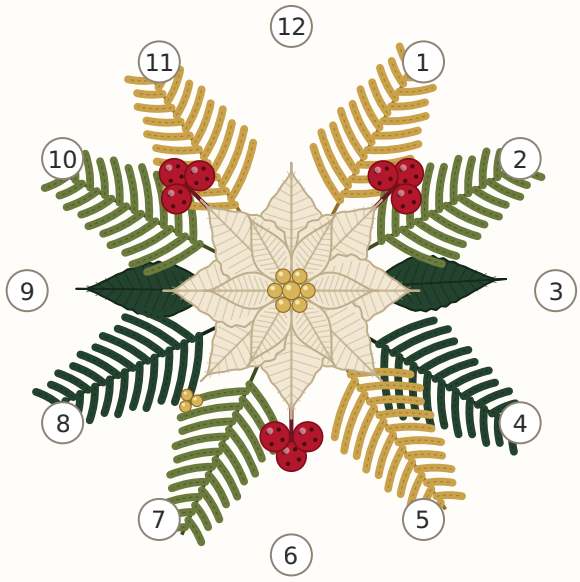
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Part 7 · Flower groups

Turn each finished flower face down. Twelve o'clock always points to the **top end** of the runner. Sew each green piece on the back of the back-layer petals, at the clock position below, with its tip pointing out. Sew only the bottom 2–3 cm of each piece so the tips stay free.



RED FLOWER GROUP (FRONT VIEW)



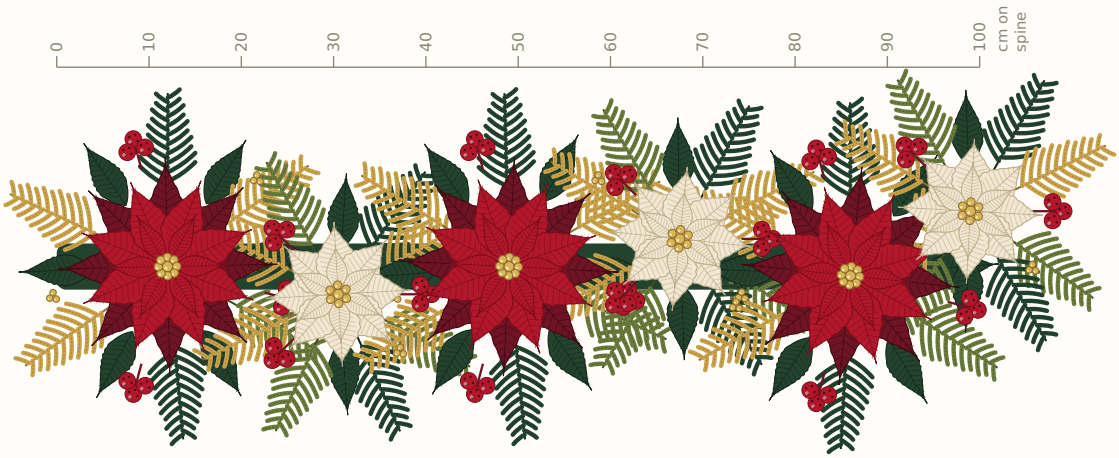
IVORY FLOWER GROUP (FRONT VIEW)

RED FLOWER	
LEAVES	2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 o'clock, base 8 cm from the centre
DARK GREEN FERNS	3, 9 o'clock
OLIVE FERNS	7 o'clock
GOLD FERNS	1, 5, 11 o'clock
FERNS	base 6.5 cm from the centre
BERRY CLUSTERS	2:30, 6:30, 9:30 o'clock, at the edge of the flower
BEAD SPRIGS	4:30, 11:30 o'clock, on top

IVORY FLOWER	
LEAVES	3, 9 o'clock, base 5 cm from the centre
DARK GREEN FERNS	4, 8 o'clock
OLIVE FERNS	2, 7, 10 o'clock
GOLD FERNS	1, 5, 11 o'clock
FERNS	base 4 cm from the centre
BERRY CLUSTERS	1:30, 6, 10:30 o'clock, at the edge of the flower
BEAD SPRIGS	7:30 o'clock, on top

Part 7 · Assembly

1. Block all pieces before you sew (see Part 8): petals, leaves and ferns lie much flatter when they are dry and shaped.
2. Make the six flower groups as shown on the previous page.
3. Lay the spine flat with the marked top end away from you.
4. Place each flower group on its pin, face up, in the order red, ivory, red, ivory, red, ivory. Let the ivory groups overlap the tips of the red bracts next to them.
5. Sew each group to the spine through its rings with small stitches, then tack the overlapping petals, leaves and ferns of neighbouring groups to each other in 2–3 places from the back.
6. Turn the runner over and check that nothing hangs loose. From the front, check that the spine is not visible; tuck an extra leaf or fern where you can still see it.



FINISHED RUNNER, ABOUT 40 × 117 CM (TOP END ON THE LEFT)

Part 8 · Finishing & care

BLOCK	Pin every piece flat on a blocking mat, right side up, and shape the points. Spray with water and let it dry.
STIFFEN	For crisp petals, brush thin fabric stiffener on the back of the bracts, petals and gold ferns. Let it dry for 24 hours before you sew.
CARE	Spot clean only. Do not machine wash: the stiffener and the beads do not like it. Store flat, or rolled loosely with tissue paper.
USE	Use on a dry table. Keep candles and open flames away: cotton burns.



AI preview image

Tips for beautiful poinsettias

TENSION	Keep the stitches firm. Loose bracts flop; firm bracts stand up.
DYE LOTS	Buy all the yarn of one colour at the same time so the shade matches.
BATCHES	Make all pieces of one kind before you start the next. It goes faster and they come out the same size.
OVERLAP	Let the pieces overlap generously. The runner in the photo looks rich because almost no table shows between the leaves.
BEADS	Check that your beads' holes fit your needle and thread before you buy them.



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